Azhar Amir Kimanje

XR & AI Engineer · Curriculum Vitae

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Simplicity is Sophistication. I'm an XR and AI engineer with a unique perspective on improving multi-sensory cognitive decision-making in medical training and challenge-based education.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Interoperability Engineer · Exonicus Inc., Seattle, WA — Jun 2024 – Present

Real-time XR trauma simulation that trains combat medics to save lives. Also Software Engineer, XR.

- Connect physiology engines, virtual patients and military training standards (HLA, JETS, MOHSES) so separate simulation systems share patient data in real time.
- Built a custom API plugin for real-time medical data communication, cutting 11 months from the MVP timeline.
- Shipped MilExTS (Meta Quest Store) and Exonicus Scenario Builder (Microsoft Store).
- Optimized data handling with Unity DOTS to process thousands of medical injuries while minimizing cache misses; standardized data categorization and naming across large medical datasets.
- Led IEEE quality assurance for mixed reality game-engine plugins and designed CI/CD pipelines; integrated JETS and MOHSES APIs with a team of 5.
- Drive collaboration in a five-company Simulation Interoperability Working Group cohort, supporting LVC training commercialized in six countries.
- Partner with US Army DEVCOM on XR usability studies; taught a workshop and demoed the platform at IMSH 2026.

Director of Mixed Reality and AI Outreach · AVELA Non-profit, Seattle, WA — Jun 2024 – Present

Director of AI × XR Labs, bringing computing and XR education to underrepresented and rural students.

- Lead on-device AI research fine-tuning small language models with Apple MLX; shipped CourseSLM on the App Store.
- Led a $200K Apple Community Education Initiative award (2026), an $80K Apple grant (2025) and a $75K UW Student Technology Fee grant (2024).
- Grew XR programs to 3,200+ STEM students a year, focused on data activism and environmental awareness, with partners including Apple Education and SPEEA ACE.
- Designed the acquisition pipeline for 30 Quest 3 headsets, 60 laptops and 30 iPads.
- Published a teaching kit on agentic AI coding on Apple's Education Community.

Founder & CEO · Sablesync, Seattle, WA — Nov 2023 – Present

Spatial computing that anyone can use; ML fine-tuning and digital-twin R&D.

- Shipped four Apple apps: Sablesync RC, Omni, 3D Reconstruction and Q-AR (see Shipped Apps).
- Built an emergency-evacuation digital twin with Unity NavMesh and navigation AI, automating floor plan to 3D model with NVIDIA Omniverse; R&D to MVP in one month with 3 engineers.
- Led AR development that cut system integration time by 50%; managed 3 engineers on real-time hardware communication, cutting development cycles by 40%.
- Integrated automated testing for AR hardware, reducing firmware errors; optimized deployment with Oculus Integration XML.

Technical Mixed Reality Lead Instructor · SPEEA Aerospace Career Enhancement (ACE), Tukwila, WA — Dec 2024 – Present

- Teach XR with computer-vision models for Gaussian splats; designed drone-based solutions for spatial planning and agriculture.
- Lead VR and AR initiatives for aerospace and sustainability projects; test and debug hardware-software communication.

Software Engineer, XR – Design Intelligence · IA Interior Architects, Seattle, WA — Jun 2024 – Sep 2024

- Verified all built-environment XR models in Unity and Autodesk Revit; built 10+ XR space plans in Unity and C#.
- Researched AI and generative AI solutions in Python; cut project time by 20% through faster cost-estimation analysis.

Augmented Reality Developer, Extern · Snap Inc., Seattle, WA — Mar 2024 – Apr 2024

- Designed AR experiences for sports businesses in Lens Studio 5.5 (beta); wrote product initiation requests and system design documents.

Lead Feature Engineer, Extended Reality Course Designer · AVELA Non-profit, Seattle, WA — Nov 2023 – Jun 2024

- Built AVELA's first 40-hour XR curriculum, increasing student STEM engagement by 25%; trained conversational AI agents in XR as teaching assistants.
- Introduced full-stack AR development and 3D model training from 360° images; delivered 80 hours of ML, AI and data-activism curriculum.

STEM Lead Instructor · AVELA Non-profit, Seattle, WA — Sep 2023 – Nov 2023

- Wrote the grants that brought XR curriculum and hardware into AVELA; taught Python, data activism and computing for environmental awareness.

Product Owner, Software Engineering Capstone · Seattle Pacific University — Sep 2023 – Jun 2024

- Built SPU GradPro, a 3D simulation of the CS degree in Unity on WebGL, with generative-AI NPCs of CS professors (the university's first conversational AI scene) and CI/CD via GitHub, Jira and Confluence.

Product Management Intern · YouthForce, Boys & Girls Clubs of America — Nov 2023 – Jan 2024

- Ran 5 beta tests of the Youthforce XR Lounge with 30 testers at a time; shipped new features in the final release to Meta App Labs.

Software Engineering Intern · YouthForce, Boys & Girls Clubs of America — Jul 2023 – Dec 2023

- Led full-stack development of the first XR lounge for the National Boys & Girls Club, cutting MVP release time by 60% in two months and raising rendering from 60 to 120 fps.

Freshman Counseling Team Lead, then Intern · SPU Undergraduate Admissions — Dec 2020 – Jun 2024

- Led 12 interns making 1,200+ outbound calls a week, helping increase enrollment by 35%; hired 3 interns from 15 interviews; helped increase minority student admission to the School of Engineering by 25%.

Early Insight Diversity Series · Citi — Mar 2024 – Apr 2024

RESEARCH & DEVELOPMENT

TCCC SBIR Phase II and IIE · Exonicus Inc. · Lead Interoperability Researcher — Jun 2024 – May 2026

Principal Investigator: Dr. Kyle Couperus

- Led research on a real-time XR medical simulation system, improving data interoperability, latency and reliability for military training.

CourseLLM · AVELA Non-profit · Principal Investigator — Jun 2025 – Sep 2025

- Led 3 PhD candidates and 6 interns fine-tuning hardware-constrained language models with Apple MLX for data sovereignty; delivered a data-activism lesson plan with Apple's Community Education Initiative; shipped as CourseSLM.

Gaussian Splats for Storytelling · AVELA Non-profit · Principal Investigator — Jan 2025 – Aug 2025

- Architected a deep-learning workflow turning 360° drone video into true-to-depth 3D environments; published with Bellevue XR Labs under the Washington Open Common Education License.

Avatar Controller Toolkit (XR ACT) · ISIA Lab, Université de Mons · Research Contributor — Jul 2024 – Present

Principal Investigator: Dr. Kevin El Haddad

- Improving the accuracy and efficiency of real-time facial landmark detection for animating facial expressions in XR.

BioDepot Workflow Builder · Morphic Lab, University of Washington Tacoma · Research Contributor — Sep 2024 – Present

Principal Investigator: Dr. Ka Yee Yeung

- A GUI that auto-installs workflow components and makes gene research reproducible for non-programmers, with Jupyter and Cytoscape support.

Wordplay · LCI Lab, University of Washington · Research Contributor — Sep 2023 – Present

Principal Investigator: Dr. Amy J. Ko

- An accessible, multilingual programming platform for interactive typography and justice-centered computing education.

PUBLICATIONS

- **Welcome to the Agentic Era: Strategic AI Implementation for Developers.** Author. Teaching kit, Apple Education Community, Community Education Initiative, Oct 2026. CC0 license.
- **From Toy to Tool: An Investigation on Student AI Use Cases and Effects.** Co-author. Presented at the World Engineering Education Forum & Global Engineering Deans Council (WEEF & GEDC) 2026, Cartagena, Colombia.
- **Tool or Toy? Student Views on ChatGPT in Culturally Responsive Computing Education: A Preliminary Study.** AVELA, 2025. ResearchGate.
- **Gaussian Splats for Storytelling.** AVELA, 2024.
- **Lessons Learned from Creating a Standard for Medical Simulation Interoperability.** Exonicus, 2024.

SHIPPED APPS

CourseSLM · On-device AI for STEM learning · AVELA	Apple App Store
MilExTS · XR trauma-care training for military teams · Exonicus	Meta Quest Store
Exonicus Scenario Builder · Trauma scenario authoring · Exonicus	Microsoft Store
Sablesync RC · LiDAR room capture to blueprints and 3D models · iPhone, iPad, Mac, Vision Pro	Apple App Store
Sablesync Omni · Photos to USDZ 3D models · iPhone, iPad, Vision Pro	Apple App Store
Sablesync 3D Reconstruction · On-device 3D reconstruction from images · Mac	Mac App Store
Sablesync Q-AR · USDZ model and animation viewer · iPhone, iPad, Mac	Apple App Store

GRANTS LED

Exonicus Inc. · XR trauma simulation and interoperability R&D · May 2024	**$1,900,000**
Exonicus Inc. · XR trauma simulation and interoperability R&D · Sep 2025	**$750,000**
Apple Community Education Initiative · On-device AI and AI education outreach across Washington State · Summer 2026	**$200,000**
Apple · On-device AI development for the AVELA community · Summer 2025	**$80,000**
UW Student Technology Fee (STF) · Expanding XR education across UW and Seattle · Sep 2024	**$75,000**
UW Student Technology Fee (STF) · XR instruction and hardware · Feb 2024	**$65,000**
Total	**$3,070,000**

AWARDS

1st Place, University of Washington Tech Showcase · Jun 2024	**$1,000**
1st Place, Top Poster Presentation Award · Seattle Pacific University · Jun 2024	**Winner**
3rd of 200, Global Eduhacks · University of Washington · Prebrief · Jun 2024	**$500**
1st, Snap Inc. Master of Augmented Reality · Apr 2024	**Internship interview**
6th of 150, Amazon AWS & Inrix Hackathon · Wanderus · Dec 2023	**Internship interview**
1st Place, Youthforce Coding Challenge · National Boys & Girls Club · Jul 2023	**$700**

SCHOLARSHIPS

Director's Grant · Seattle Pacific University · 2020 – 2024	**$8,000 / year**
Washington Bridge Grant · Seattle Pacific University · 2020 – 2024	**$3,000 / year**
Culture Tech Legacy Google, Masterclass and LinkedIn Learning Scholarships · 2024	**Fully paid certifications**

MEDIA COVERAGE

- **AVELA researchers present at WEEF & GEDC 2026**, AVELA UW, Oct 2026. Co-author of the presented paper.
- **Welcome to the Agentic Era**, Apple Education Community, Oct 2026. Author of the teaching kit.
- **Startup Spotlight Sessions, Seattle Startup Hall**, Exonicus, Aug 2026. Represented Exonicus as Lead Engineer.
- **Exonicus at the IMSH 2026 Vendor Showcase**, HealthySimulation.com video, Jan 2026. On-camera product walkthrough.
- **Workshop: From Zero to Scenario**, IMSH 2026, San Antonio, Jan 12, 2026. Instructor.
- **Exonicus exhibits at IMSH 2026, Booth #104**, Jan 2026. On-site team.

- **FIRST Responder SBIR Phase II Touchpoint**, Fort Gordon, Georgia, Jul 2025. Demonstrated the Exonicus Trauma Simulator.
- **Meet the Class of 2024**, Seattle Pacific University Commencement, Jun 2024. Profile.
- **Live@5 Guest List**, SynED. Guest.

LEADERSHIP

- **Regional Executive Board Finance Chair**, National Society of Black Engineers, Puget Sound region, Jul 2024 – Nov 2024. Managed corporate partnerships and conference financial planning ($160,000).
- **Founder & President**, NSBE Seattle Pacific University Chapter, Sep 2023 – Jun 2024.
- **Program budget**, Director of Mixed Reality Outreach, AVELA Non-profit, Jun 2024 – Present ($150,000).

ORGANIZATIONS

- Simulation Interoperability Standards Organization (SISO), Medical Modeling & Simulation Community, through Exonicus, 2025 – Present.
- Alliance for OpenUSD (AOUSD), through Sablesync, 2025 – Present.
- Apple Community Education Initiative (CEI), AI education partner, through AVELA.
- Northwest XR EDU Network (NW XR EDU), through AVELA, 2024 – Present.

CERTIFICATES

Microsoft	Azure Digital Twins; Connect IoT Data to Mixed Reality with Azure Digital Twins and Unity; Introduction to Azure Digital Twins; Mixed Reality and Azure Digital Twins; Office Specialist: Excel Associate (2024)
Unity	VR Development; Shaders and Materials; Data-Oriented Design and Entity Component Modeling; Junior Programmer (2023 – 2024)
LinkedIn Learning	CISSP: Identity and Access Management; Generative AI for Product Managers; Web Programming Foundations; C# Development (2023 – 2024)
Google	Connect and Protect: Networks and Network Security; Foundations of Cybersecurity; Play It Safe: Manage Security Risks (2024)
Meta · Snap · Exonicus	Meta Spark Foundations of AR (2024); Snap Master of AR Development (2024); OPSEC Awareness for Military Members and DoD Employees (2024)
Other	3D Graphics on the Web with Three.js

SKILLS

Programming	C# (5+ years), C++, Swift, Python, C, SQL, Java
Spatial & 3D	Unity (DOTS, NavMesh), Unreal, OpenXR, RealityKit, ARKit, ARCore, USDZ / OpenUSD, LiDAR capture, Gaussian splatting, NVIDIA Omniverse, three.js, .NET
AI & vision	Apple MLX fine-tuning, small language models, computer vision, deep learning, NLP, generative AI, rapid prototyping
Simulation	HLA, JETS, MOHSES, real-time data synchronization, CI/CD
Spoken languages	Luganda (native), English (native), Spanish (elementary)

VOLUNTEER WORK

- XR Technical Support and Student Volunteer, National Boys & Girls Club, Seattle, WA (current).
- Scholarship Essay Writing Support and Coding Instructor, AVELA Non-profit (current).
- Welcome Team, Seattle Pacific University, Nov 2023 – Jun 2024.

EDUCATION

B.A., Computer Science and Engineering · Seattle Pacific University, Seattle, WA — Sep 2020 – Jun 2024